

TIPS FOR BUYING A LASER PRINTER

- 1. Be clear about what your actual requirements are:** Look for important features and decide what you want your laser printer to do. Laser printers can be evaluated on speed, volume, scalability and expandability. If your print volume is over 100 pages per day and you don't need colour, you may want to look at the faster laser printers. For a small home-office (SOHO) set-up, you need a combination of scanner, printer, copier and fax machine, i.e., a multi-function laser printer.
- 2. Judge the features accurately:**
 - *Operating cost*—Calculate the cost of replacing cartridges and paper. The cost of paper, toner and ink can amount to more than the original cost of the printer, within a year or so.
 - *Mobile printing*—If you have an iPhone or iPad, this feature will enable effortless printing from these devices.
 - *Secure printing*—If you need to print confidential documents over password protected print jobs, this feature is a must.
 - *Speed*—The printer's speed is very important if you are printing a large number of black and white documents.
 - *Network-enabled/Wi-Fi*—Depending on what your office's requirements are, you now have a choice between printers with built-in Wi-Fi and those that are network enabled.
 - *Ease of use*—Go in for the plug-and-play printers that are easy to set up.
 - *Warranty*—Check the manufacturer's warrant—obviously, the longer the better.
- 3. Cartridges:** Cartridge and paper costs can exceed the acquisition cost several times over. Laser printers cost a little more to buy but much less to use—they are very cost effective to operate since their toner cartridges are not replaced as often.
- 4. Stay within budget:** Do an online search for your requirements and set a benchmark on printer prices. Decide on how much money you want to spend and do not go over this budget.
- 5. Compare and shop:** Do not get confused by the plethora of imaging and printing brands in the market. Look at the following aspects and compare:
 - The major players in the market
 - Best after-sales service
 - Better warranty
 - Consumer offers
 - Eco-friendliness

Now collate all the data and choose the right printer for your needs.

- 6. Caring for your printer:** Always buy genuine cartridges for your printer, to enhance your printer's life and print quality. Do not refill, as it will reduce the print quality and damage your printer. Keep your device covered when not in use, to avoid microscopic dust entering the machine and clogging the cartridges.

—Inputs from Canon India

Some laser printers to look out for in the market

Canon imageCLASS MF4570dw

Compact and reliable, the Canon imageCLASS MF4570dw is a multifunctional laser printer that offers the ideal print-scan-copy-fax solution, with auto-duplex printing and Wi-Fi connectivity. This printer offers reasonable speed and output quality, along with all the MFP features you're likely to need for a small business.

Price: ₹ 30,995

Specifications:

Printer type:	Laser
Print speed:	25/26ppm (A4/LTR)
First Printout Time (FPOT):	6.0/5.8secs (A4/LTR)
Print language:	UFR II LT (Host-based)
Print resolution:	600×600 dpi, 1200×600 dpi
Duplex print:	Yes
Print memory:	64 MB (shared)

